



The not-too-bad-but-could-have-been-better photo

Now that we've decided what we want the skin to look like, it's time to bring the mask into the picture. Create a new Hide All mask by Alt-Clicking on the Create Layer Mask button.

Step II: Painting

Use the Brush tool [B], right-click on the image to bring up the brush picker, and pick a soft-edged brush. You will be tweaking the size quite often, so keep your hand on the “[” key to increase and “]” to decrease the size. Make sure the layer mask is selected, and with the foreground colour as white, begin painting on the skin. Avoid painting on areas like the hair, eyes, eyebrows, lips or nostrils—we don't want to lose any detail there. You should see the effect coming out quite nicely now.



If you look closely, you'll see the pores vanish. No face-cream, though